

Interview Guide - Chaos Cat

Open-ended interview guide for evaluating the usability and understandability of the interactive system.

System	Chaos Cat - an interactive robotic cat that communicates through movement, LED colors, sound, touch input, ultrasonic sensing, and tail movement.
Goal	Understand how participants interpret the cat's behavior, emotional modes, feedback signals, and interaction flow.
Duration	Approx. 10-15 minutes after a short interaction with the prototype.

Interview Setup

- 1 Ask the participant to interact freely with Chaos Cat first.
- 2 Avoid explaining the modes before the main questions, so their first interpretation is not influenced.
- 3 Use follow-up prompts such as: "Can you tell me more?", "What made you think that?", and "How did that feel?"

Warm-up Questions

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| 1 | Can you tell us about your previous experience with robots, interactive toys, or playful technical systems? | <i>Probe for familiar systems, expectations, and confidence with technology.</i> |
| 2 | When you use an unfamiliar device, how do you usually figure out what it is doing or what it expects from you? | <i>Probe for preferred clues: sound, movement, lights, labels, trial and error.</i> |
| 3 | What kind of behavior would you expect from a small interactive robotic cat? | <i>Probe for emotional reactions, movement, safety, and personality expectations.</i> |

Main Questions

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| 1 | Looking at Chaos Cat for the first time, what do you think its purpose is and how would you describe it? | <i>Probe for first impression and whether the concept is recognizable.</i> |
| 2 | During the interaction, how did you understand which mode or emotional state the cat was in? | <i>Probe for Passive, Happy, Angry, and Afraid mode recognition.</i> |
| 3 | Which feedback signals were easiest or hardest to interpret: movement, LED color, sound, tail movement, or direction changes? | <i>Probe for clarity, timing, and possible conflicting signals.</i> |
| 4 | How natural or clear was the interaction through touching the copper foil? | <i>Probe for whether the touch input felt discoverable and responsive.</i> |
| 5 | How did the transition from Passive to Happy and then to Angry feel to you? | <i>Probe for whether the timing felt too fast, too slow, surprising, or understandable.</i> |
| 6 | What did you expect Chaos Cat to do when it reached the table edge or entered Afraid mode? | <i>Probe for safety, trust, and whether the backwards movement made sense.</i> |
| 7 | Which parts of the behavior felt enjoyable, surprising, annoying, or unclear? | <i>Probe for emotional response and usability problems.</i> |
| 8 | If someone had to use Chaos Cat without an explanation, what would help them understand it faster? | <i>Probe for possible improvements in feedback, onboarding, or physical design.</i> |

Closing Questions

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| 1 | What would you change or improve to make Chaos Cat easier or more enjoyable to interact with? | <i>Probe for concrete design improvements.</i> |
| 2 | Is there anything else you noticed that we did not ask about? | <i>Give the participant space for final thoughts.</i> |

Note for interviewer: Keep the conversation open and neutral. Ask follow-up questions when participants mention confusion, surprise, or expectations about the system.